Asylum Seekers and Canadian Voters: Examining the 2015 Syrian Refugee Crisis

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Introduction

In 2015, the Syrian civil war caused one of the biggest refugee crises worldwide in recent years. In response, the Canadian government initiated a major refugee resettlement program and welcomed a significant number of Government-Assisted Refugees (GARs). This policy aimed to provide safe haven for displaced persons and promote their long-term integration into Canadian society. However, the rapid inflow of refugees led to extensive public discussions about the possible effects of immigration on local communities, public services, and political views. Immigration has become an important political issue in many advanced democracies because the change in population composition may influence public opinion and electoral results. Many studies show that sudden refugee inflow is related to a change in political views. In some situations, increasing support for right-wing or anti-immigration parties.

The core questions of this study are: What is the relationship between immigration and partisanship? What is the impact of large refugee flows on voting intentions in Canada? In order to observe the relationship between immigration and voting, we needed a quasi- experimental shock to show causation. Thus, we focus on the sudden inflow of Syrian refugees because it represents a policy-driven demographic shock rather than a long-term immigration trend. This also reduces identification problems from general immigrants, and the humanitarian aspect provides clearer conditions for analysing extremist attitudes. This report examines the impact of immigration on partisanship and its relation to political extremism through the following:

- a review of how to define right-wing extremism
- an immigrant sentiment analysis on vote shares
- a difference-in-difference analysis on the Syrian Refugee Crisis

Given that our Capstone theme is on extremism, we first set out to understand and identify the social and political mechanisms associated with right-wing extremism. Following Carter's (2018) framework, we operationalize right-wing extremism through shifts in conservative vote intention driven by anti-immigrant sentiment—if negative attitudes toward immigration are systematically associated with support for anti-immigrant parties, this reflects the kind of xenophobic political mobilization Carter identifies as extremism's secondary manifestation.

To examine this, we first establish whether anti-immigrant sentiment is associated with conservative vote intention through a sentiment analysis on immigration attitudes and vote shares. This is a necessary first step because if no such association exists, refugee exposure would have little theoretical reason to shift voting behaviour in a right-wing direction. Having established that relationship, we then use the Syrian Refugee Crisis as a quasi-experimental shock to test whether actual refugee exposure causally produces the kind of anti-immigrant mobilization our sentiment analysis suggests is possible. We hypothesize that negative immigration sentiment is associated with voting intention for the conservative party and that refugee influx causes greater support for the conservative party, together forming a two-step test of whether immigration can drive right-wing extremism in the Canadian context.

Literature Review

Elizabeth Cater (2018) in her study, *Right-wing extremism/radicalism: reconstructing the concept*, redefined right-wing extremism/radicalism using Mudde's influential 1995 study as a foundation. It canvases recent academic literature to explore how the concept has been understood and argues for a redefining of the concept to encompass authoritarianism, anti-democracy and exclusionary and/or holistic nationalism. Accordingly, the study defines

right-wing extremism through authoritarianism and anti-democratic values, framing its "secondary" manifestations as the xenophobic or anti-immigrant rhetoric deployed during perceived crises. This is because exposure to large migration inflows leads to democratic backsliding with increased support for the radical right and stricter immigration, an outcome usually driven by xenophobia. There are several studies, especially in Europe, on whether immigrants impact the political condition of host countries. In particular, Salathé et al (2025) did a review of 123 quantitative studies, and their analysis showed that refugee shocks tend to be associated with an increase in votes for the radical right.

Many studies have also been conducted in Europe on the Syrian Refugee crisis, and most of these studies have shown that there has been increased support for conservative and far-right politics. Similar to this study, Dinas et al. (2019) and Altındağ and Neeraj (2021) have done difference-in-differences analyses on the Aegean Islands in Greece and in Turkey using the Syrian Refugee crisis as a shock event and found that it did fuel support for right-wing and far-right politics. Both studies compare the political outcomes in geographic areas with high versus low intensities of refugee presence before and after the beginning of the Syrian Civil War. The findings suggest that the refugees had small effects on voters and a negligible effect on actual voting outcomes. Despite polarized attitudes towards Syrian refugees, voters did not hold the majority party responsible for the Syrian refugees.

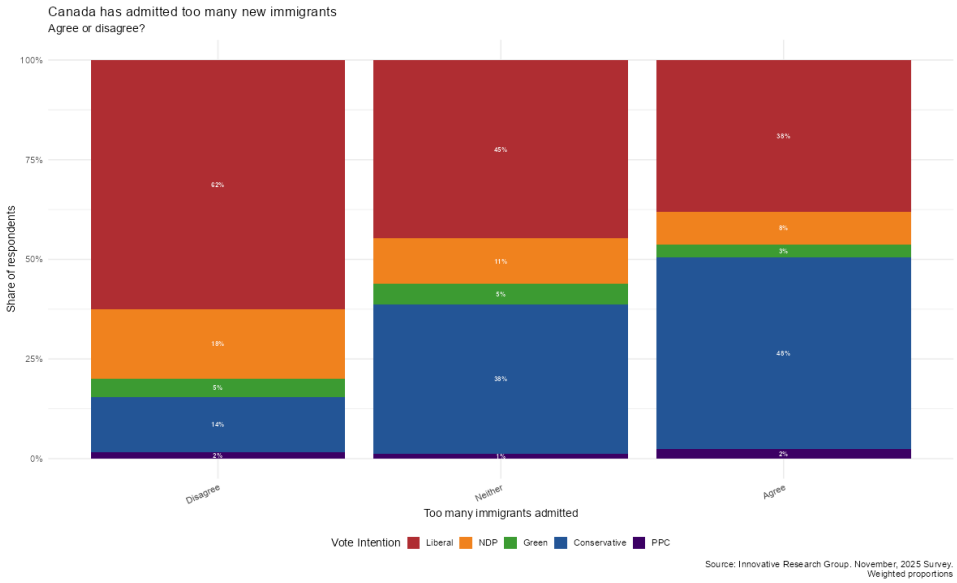
Similarly, Campo et al. (2024) examined the effects of a refugee crisis on right-wing populism in Italy with a specific focus on right-wing populism as a dependent variable. Results showed that the presence of asylum seekers does not seem to affect the share of preferences for the center-right and the electoral turnout. In Germany, multiple studies on the impact of refugees and migrants on voting behaviour have also shown similar results (Bredtmann, 2022; Gamalerio

et al., 2023; Endrich, 2024; Fremerey et al., 2024). While the refugee crisis significantly increased the support for anti-immigration parties in the statistical analyses, the impact is small in magnitude. Through these studies, it appears that a study of refugee presence on voting behaviour in Canada would follow a similar pattern, given the similar economic status and democratic governance in the European countries used as case studies.

Immigration Sentiment Analysis

Anti-Immigrant Sentiment Across Party Voters

Figure 1: Federal Vote Intention by Immigration Sentiment



Before we explore the causal relationship between refugee settlement and party support, we explore the association between federal vote intention and immigration sentiment. Data used was sourced from Statistics Canada (2012) to provincially locate respondents based on their postal code and Innovative Research Group's (2025) survey. Respondents were asked whether they agreed or disagreed that Canada has admitted too many new immigrants in the last five years. We use their answer to construct Figure 1, which shows the distribution of responses within each federal party's voter base, weighted using a national survey weight.

We find that immigration sentiment has a pattern that varies with federal party support. Left-leaning voters show negative associations with the statement, such as NDP and Green voters, who mostly disagree, along with Liberal voters who disagree at 62% compared to 38% who agree. On the other hand, right-leaning parties like Conservative voters show a positive association, with only 14% disagree and 42% agree, indicating that negative attitudes on immigration are focused among right-leaning voters. People's Party (PPC), which is well-known in Canada as a far-right party, does not vary with respondents' answers, largely due to its small sample size of 21 observations. However, we are still left with a clear picture that people's party of choice varies with their views on immigration.

Variation In Immigration Support

To test this relationship and identify the characteristics associated with immigration sentiment, we use a weighted ordinal logistic regression on the same statement as the outcome, where our results will be the odds of each category within an independent variable of choosing to agree. Our primary independent variable of interest is federal party vote intention, with Liberal voters as the reference category, given their more centrist identification for comparisons in both directions. We also control for age, income, education, gender and province in the model.

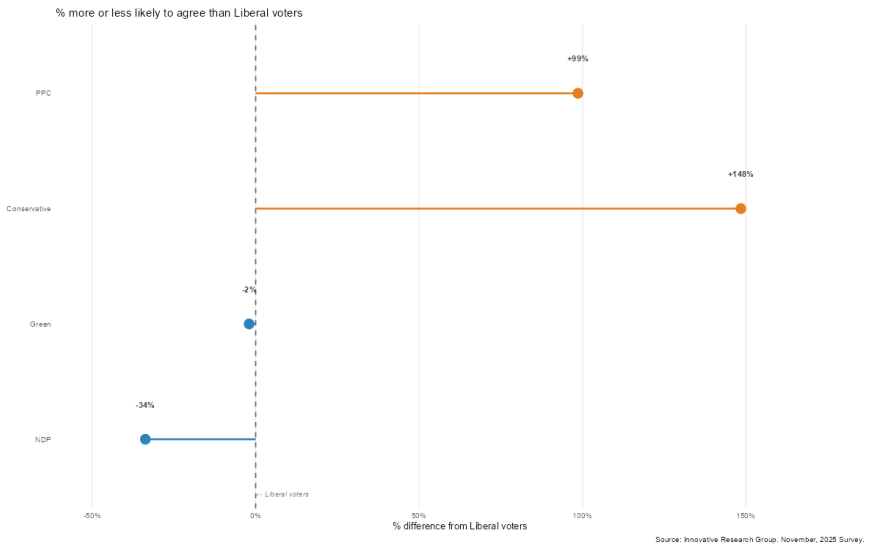
Model Specification:

$$\text{logit}[P(Y <= j)] = \theta j - (\beta 1\text{Vote} + \beta 2\text{Age} + \beta 3\text{Income} + \beta 4\text{Education} + \beta 5\text{Gender} + \beta 6\text{Province})$$

Where:

- logit[P(Y <= j)] is the log of our outcome Y, which is the statement ordered from disagree, neither, and agree
- θj are threshold intercepts for the outcome

Figure 2: Difference from Liberal supporters for Federal Vote Intention



Shown in Figure 2, federal party support had two statistically significant parties: Conservative and NDP. Conservative voters show 2.49 times higher odds of agreeing compared to Liberal voters ($p<0.001$), showing a positive association. NDP voters show 34% lower odds than Liberal voters ($p<0.1$), showing a negative association. Although Green and PPC were not significant, their directions are expected, with Green voters less likely and PPC voters more likely than Liberal voters to agree.

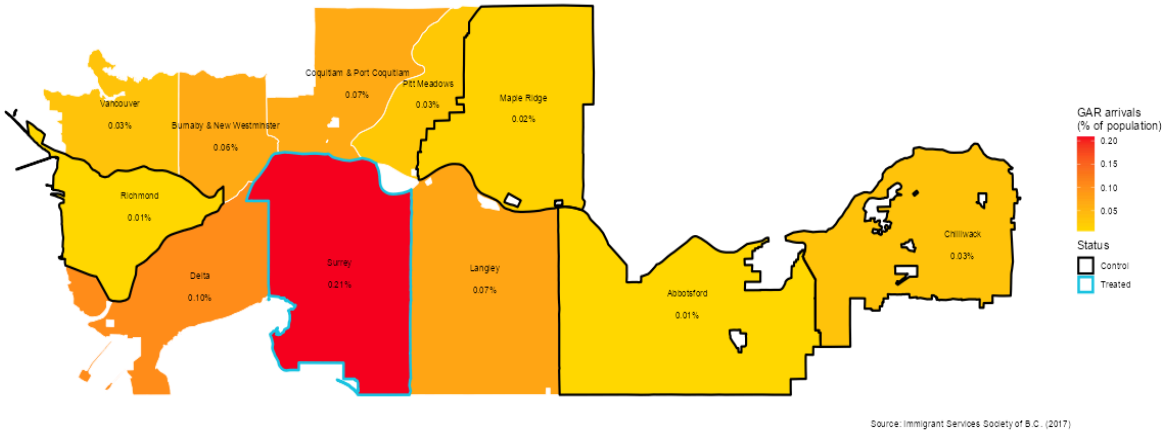
Other significant factors shown in the appendix under Table 1 were in education, age, and province. Individuals with a high school diploma or without any formal certificate show 47% higher odds of agreeing ($p<0.1$), and those with college or trades education show 56% higher odds ($p<0.05$), both compared to those with at least some university education. Respondents aged 35 to 54 show 43% higher odds than those aged 18 to 34 ($p<0.1$). Residents from Quebec show 48% lower odds ($p<0.01$), British Columbia residents show 42% lower odds ($p<0.05$), and Atlantic provinces and territories show 52% lower odds ($p<0.01$) than residents from Ontario.

Taken together, immigration sentiment in Canada is not randomly distributed but associated with both political affiliation and socioeconomic characteristics. Conservative supporters show significantly higher odds of agreeing, while NDP supporters show the opposite preference, representing the shift in sentiment as we move from left to right. Additionally, immigration attitudes are also shaped by educational levels, age, and provincial location. Where individuals in the 35 to 54 age range and those with lower formal education express higher odds compared to younger and university-educated individuals, these characteristics are typically seen among people who face employment competition that can be intensified by newcomers. While residents of Atlantic provinces and territories, British Columbia, and Quebec show lower odds than those from Ontario, reflecting their own cultural differences and exposure to immigrants, which would shape their attitudes.

Event Study: The 2015 Syrian Refugee Crisis

The Syrian Refugee crisis began in March, 2011 following a violent government crackdown on public demonstrations in defence of teenagers who were arrested for anti-government graffiti in Daraa, Syria. Their arrest led to several public protests throughout Syria, which were met with violence by the security forces under Syria's Assad Government and eventually escalated into a civil war that forced millions of Syrians to flee their homes (UNHCR, 2025). In 2015, the resettlement of millions of Syrian refugees—notably in countries like Turkey, Lebanon and Germany— became internationally recognized as the 'Syrian Refugee Crisis'. Canada responded by introducing an unprecedented program that rapidly resettled 25,000 Syrian refugees in roughly 100 days and the total number of Syrian refugees admitted into Canada has surpassed 100,000 as of today.

Figure 3: GAR Arrivals as a share of municipality population



Between November 4th, 2015 and December 31st, 2016, British Columbia (BC) received over 3600 Syrian government-assisted refugees (GARs), of which 1881 settled in the Lower Mainland (Immigrant Services Society of B.C., 2017). Figure 3 displays these GAR arrivals

in the Lower Mainland as a share of each municipality's population as of 2016 (Immigrant

Services Society of B.C., 2017; Bergmann et al., 2018). Where settlement was concentrated in our treatment municipality, Surrey, which received 1082 GARs, about 43% of BC arrivals, due to relatively affordable and large rental units to accommodate families, Immigrant Services of BC's base of operations in Surrey that facilitates a large preexisting immigrant and refugee population with community networks (Immigrant Services Society of B.C., 2017). Abbotsford, Chilliwack, Maple Ridge, and Richmond are our controls, which received fewer GARs each due to limitations in housing availability and affordability, and with smaller immigrant communities, creating a disparity in immigration levels amongst different cities (Immigrant Services Society of B.C., 2017). The treated and control groups will be used in our difference-in-difference analysis to estimate the relative effects.

There have been differing views on the arrival and integration of refugees across the country. While many argue that Canada's refugee policies are constrained and refugees are treated as security threats, others have argued for stricter border and immigration policies amidst challenges on rising prices, affordable housing and public services in Canada (Nafziger, 2015; Zhu, 2025). From 2015 to 2020, Syrian Refugees have been consistently covered by news outlets such as CBC and Vancouver Sun. Specifically in January 2016, a group of Syrian refugees were attacked by an unknown man on a bicycle which prompted a response from Justin Trudeau who publicly condemned the hate crime towards Syrian Refugees on X (formerly Twitter) (Canadian Immigration Lawyers Association, 2024; CBC News, 2015, 2016a, 2016b; Challinor, 2021; Korstrom, 2015; Singer, 2015; Todd, 2024). This shows that the Syrian Refugee Crisis has made its way into public consciousness and asylum seekers play a role in Canadians' understanding of the sociopolitical landscape.

Despite a 2019 Gallup survey finding that Canada had the world's most welcoming and positive attitude toward immigrants, by fall of 2024, an Angus Reid poll found that more than one in five Canadians said immigration was one of the top issues facing the country (Keller, 2025). Since 2025, Bill C-12 has been making headlines recently, a bill which has been described by the media as an 'attack on refugee, migrant rights', many advocates and human rights groups have also said this bill will put thousands 'at risk of persecution, violence and precarity' (Al Jazeera, 2026). This has made the issue of immigration and refugees very prevalent.

Difference-in-Differences Model & Analysis

Having established that immigration attitudes vary systematically by party, we now turn to whether actual refugee exposure shifted those voting intentions. To estimate the causal effect

of large-scale refugee resettlement on voting intentions, this study uses a Difference-in-Differences (DiD) approach. The core idea is that, rather than only examining associations between immigration and voting intention, we aim to identify a causal impact. We compare Surrey to a group of similar BC cities that did not receive large numbers of refugees. By examining how the gap between Surrey and these control cities evolves after 2015, relative to the pre-2015 period, we can more cleanly isolate the effect of resettlement.

Model Specification

The model estimates the probability that a given respondent intends to vote Conservative, as a function of whether they live in Surrey and whether the survey was conducted after resettlement began. Formally, the model is:

$$P(Vote\ Conservative)_{it} = \beta 0 + \beta 1(Surrey \times Post)_{it} + \beta 2Age_{it} + \beta 3Gender_{it} + \beta 4Income_{it} + \gamma_i + \delta_t + \varepsilon_{it}$$

The dependent variable is a binary outcome equal to 1 if the respondent reports an intention to vote Conservative and 0 otherwise. Post equals 1 for all survey waves from 2016 onward—the years following resettlement—and 0 for years before. Surrey equals 1 for respondents living in Surrey and 0 for those in the control cities.

The key variable is the interaction term Surrey × Post, the intervention effect. This equals 1 only for Surrey respondents surveyed after resettlement, and captures the DiD estimate: how much Conservative vote intention changed in Surrey relative to the control cities after 2015. Its coefficient, β1, is the main result of interest.

The model also controls for age, gender, and income at the individual level. City fixed effects (γi) absorb any stable differences between municipalities, for example, the fact that Surrey already had higher baseline Conservative support than some control cities. Year fixed

effects (δt) account for province-wide trends that affected all cities equally in a given year, such as national shifts in partisan support. Survey data come from the Canadian Tracking Model (CTM) polls conducted by Innovative Research Group from April 2012 to April 2018.

Checking Whether the Comparison Makes Sense

Before interpreting any results, it is important to check whether comparing Surrey to the control cities is actually a fair comparison. In this design, the control cities serve as a stand-in for what Surrey would've trended had it not received large-scale refugee resettlement. For that to work, both groups need to have been moving in similar directions before 2015, so that any post-2015 divergence can be attributed to the resettlement rather than pre-existing divergences.

Looking at the data from 2012 to 2015 in Figure 4, Surrey consistently showed higher Conservative support than the control cities. This is not a problem in itself, what matters is not that both groups start at the same level, but that they move in the same direction over time. In this regard, the figure is mixed; there are periods when Surrey and the control cities move in a similar direction (2012-2013), and others when they diverge slightly (2013-2014). Rather than relying on this visual check alone, we test the assumption more formally using an event study.

Figure 4

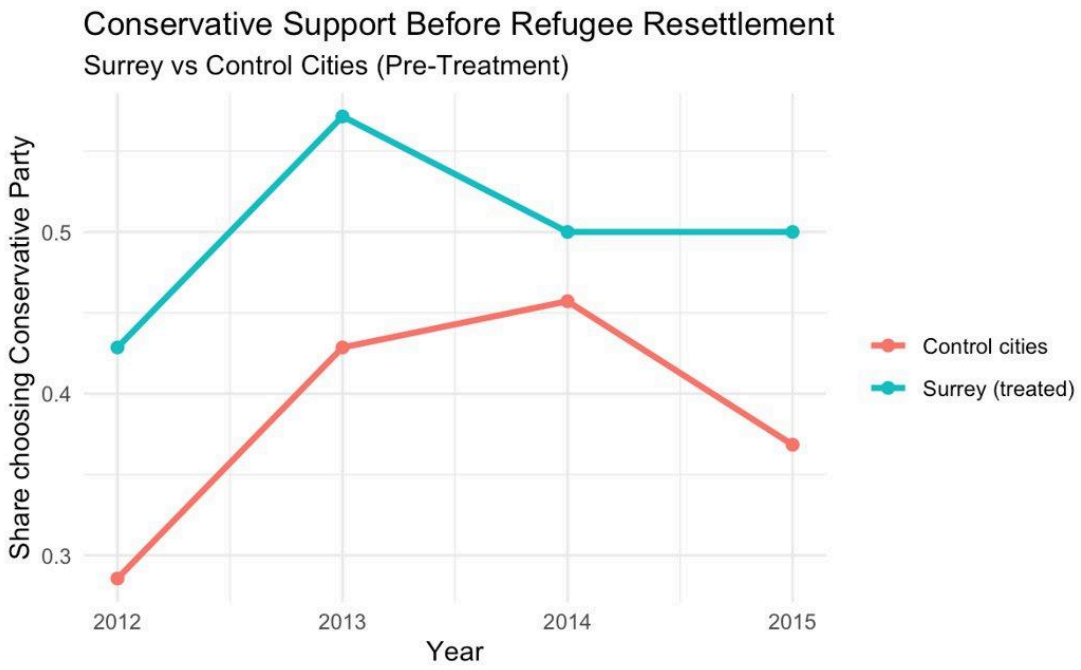


Figure 4. Pre-treatment trends in Conservative vote intention for Surrey (treated) and control cities. Source: Innovative Research Group CTM surveys, April 2012–April 2018.

Event Study: Formally Testing the Assumption

The purpose of the event study is to test whether the pre-treatment divergence between Surrey and the control cities was due to chance. If the gaps in the years before resettlement are small and statistically indistinguishable from zero, we can confidently say the two groups were on a similar path before the resettlement. The event study estimates the gap in Conservative support between Surrey and the control cities in each year from 2012 to 2018, using 2015 as the reference point. Each point in Figure 5 shows how much Surrey differed from the control cities each year relative to that 2015 baseline, along with a 95 percent confidence interval around each estimate. In the years before resettlement (2012 to 2014), none of the estimated gaps were

statistically significant. The confidence intervals all include zero, meaning there is no detectable difference between how Surrey and the control cities were trending before the policy. This validates the comparison: without large-scale resettlement, Surrey would likely have followed the same trend as the control cities.

The post-treatment years offer an early signal about the direction of the main result. From 2016 to 2018, all year-specific estimates are negative, suggesting that Conservative support in Surrey fell relative to the control cities after resettlement. However, none of these estimates are statistically significant, meaning we cannot rule out that this pattern occurred by chance.

Figure 5

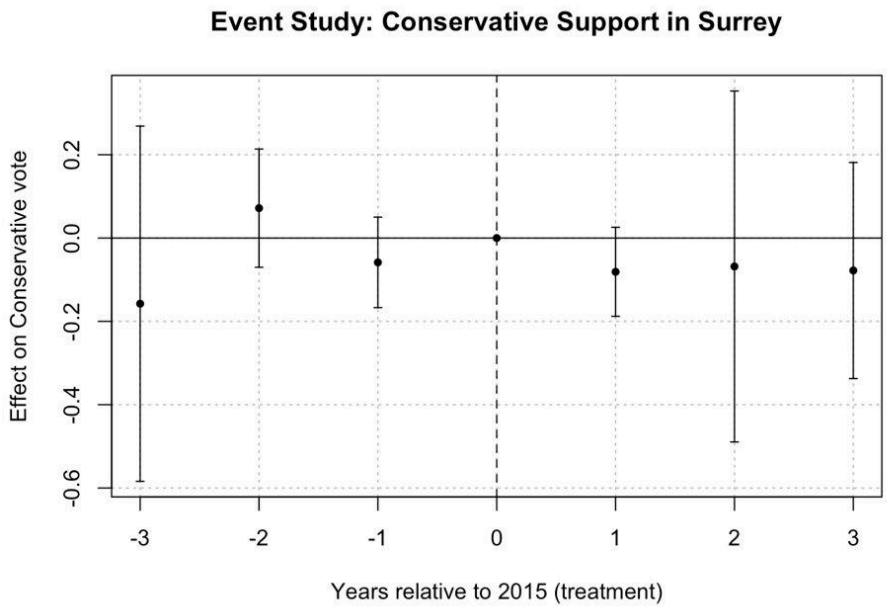


Figure 5. Event study estimates of the gap in Conservative vote intention between Surrey and control cities, using 2015 as the baseline year. Error bars represent 95% confidence intervals. Source: Innovative Research Group CTM surveys, April 2012–April 2018.

Results

Figure 6 shows the DiD results visually. The green line shows Surrey's actual Conservative support over time. The blue dashed line shows what we would have expected Surrey to look like had it not received large-scale resettlement, based on how the control cities trended after 2015—in other words, the counterfactual. The shaded blue area between them represents our estimated effect of resettlement on the conservative vote.

The main result is a coefficient of −0.067 on the Surrey × Post interaction term (Table 2). This translates to an average drop of about 6.7 percentage points in Conservative vote intention in Surrey relative to control cities after resettlement. Rather than an increase in support for a right-wing party, the data point toward a modest decline in conservative support in the community most directly exposed to the arrivals.

However, this result is not statistically significant. There is approximately a 48 percent chance of observing an estimate this large even if there were no real effect, well above the standard 5 percent threshold. We therefore cannot confidently say that resettlement changed voting behaviour in Surrey. The wide confidence intervals visible in the event study reflect this uncertainty, driven largely by the limited number of survey respondents available at the city-year level.

What the model does allow us to say is that large increases in Conservative support can be ruled out. At the 95 percent confidence level, increases greater than roughly 12 percentage points are very unlikely. Even if we cannot identify the precise effect of resettlement on voting, we can say with confidence that no large right-wing mobilization took place in Surrey following the arrival of Syrian refugees.

Figure 6

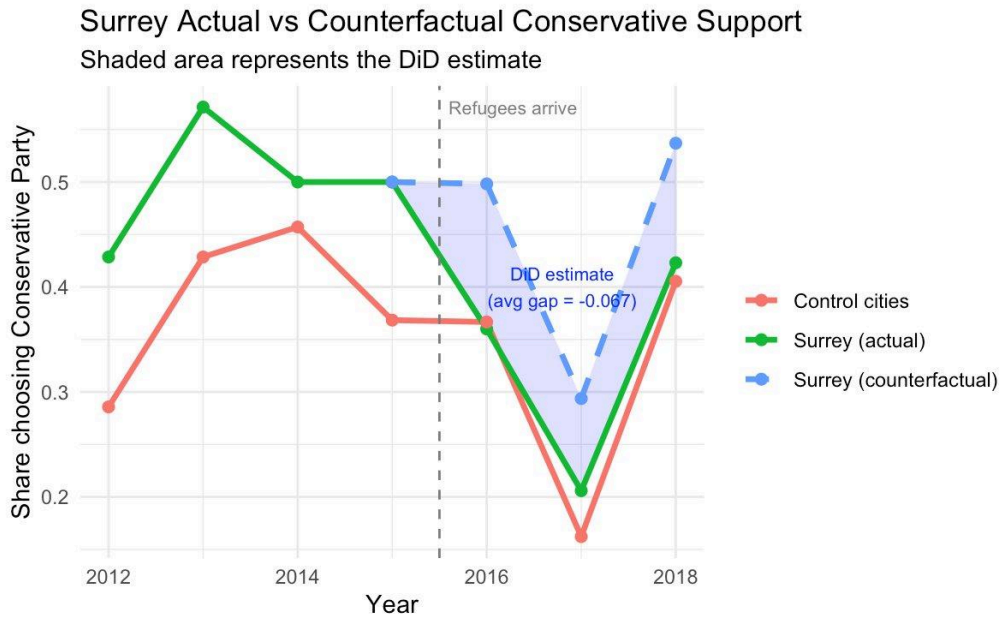


Figure 6. Difference-in-Differences results. The green line shows Surrey's actual Conservative vote share; the blue dashed line shows the estimated counterfactual based on control city trends post-2015. The shaded area represents the DiD estimate (avg. gap = −0.067). Source: Innovative Research Group CTM surveys, April 2012–April 2018.

Limitations

Limitations of the Difference-in-Differences Model

While the DiD approach is well-suited to this kind of policy question, several limitations affect how confidently we can interpret the results.

Separating resettlement from the 2015 election. The most significant challenge is that we cannot fully separate the effect of refugee resettlement from Justin Trudeau's federal election victory in October 2015. Both events happened at virtually the same time. Any post-2015 shift in Conservative support could therefore reflect a broader national political change—voters moving away from the Conservatives following the election result—rather than a local response to resettlement in Surrey.

Control cities also received some refugees. Cities like Abbotsford and Richmond are treated as unaffected comparisons, but they did receive small numbers of Syrian refugees during the same period. This means the comparison is not perfectly clean. If resettlement had any effect on voting in those cities too—even a small one—our estimate of Surrey's effect would be pulled toward zero.

Small sample sizes reduce precision. The number of survey respondents per city per year is limited, producing less precise estimates. This is reflected in the wide confidence intervals throughout the event study. A 6.7 percentage point effect might reach statistical significance with a larger sample—the data simply do not give us enough observations to be confident either way.

Annual surveys miss within-year changes. Because the survey data are collected once a year, we cannot observe short-term shifts in attitudes that may have occurred within a given year—for example, immediately after refugees arrived or in response to specific events like the January 2016 hate crime against Syrian refugees in Surrey that attracted significant national media coverage.

Missing controls. The model controls for age, gender, and income but does not include education level or immigration status—both known predictors of immigration attitudes and vote choice. If these variables are distributed differently between Surrey and the control cities, their omission could introduce some bias into the estimates.

Limitations of Immigration Sentiment Analysis

Vague immigration statement. The statement used to measure sentiment gets a general view of respondents' attitudes, but answers can be based on multiple reasons, such as economic opinions, personal bias, or even xenophobic behaviour, which inflates the correlation. A more targeted question would have been preferred, especially one in line with our main analysis on refugees.

Bloc Québécois exclusion. Bloc Québécois was excluded from the analysis due to perfect collinearity with Quebec in controlling the province, as all its supporters were from Quebec in the sample. This prevents capturing Bloc Québécois supporter views on immigration.

People's Party (PPC) sample size. The limited sample size of PPC supporters in the data prevents capturing the relationship between people who support a far-right party and their views on immigration. A larger size would show a more extremist take on the analysis.

Grouped provinces. To improve the model, some provinces had to be grouped as they had few observations in the sample, such as Prairie and Atlantic provinces with territories. While it was necessary for the model, it prevents identifying how each province varies with the statement. It would be better to have data with enough observations in each province.

Interpreting the DiD Results

The Difference-in-Differences results point to a consistent finding: the large-scale arrival of Syrian refugees in Surrey in 2015–2016 was not associated with a statistically significant increase in Conservative vote intention. The estimated effect, a 6.7 percentage point drop in Conservative support, runs opposite to what we would expect. While this estimate is too uncertain to treat as conclusive on its own, the data do allow us to rule out one specific outcome: a large right-wing backlash. Increases in Conservative support above roughly 12 percentage points can be ruled out at the 95 percent confidence level.

This absence of backlash is worth examining. One likely explanation is how the crisis was framed in Canadian public life. The 2015 Syrian refugee intake was presented overwhelmingly as a humanitarian response to a war, rather than as a security concern or economic burden. This kind of framing tends to activate public sympathy rather than the sense of

threat that typically drives voters toward parties with stricter immigration platforms. When refugees are seen as people fleeing persecution, the political dynamics of large arrivals can look very different from cases where arrival is unplanned or framed around risk.

The way resettlement was organized may also matter. Canada's government-assisted model placed 25,000 refugees in roughly 100 days but did so through a structured network of designated housing, language support, and settlement agencies such as ISSofBC. This structure may have reduced the visible disruption—overcrowding, competition for services, and public disorder—that tends to generate political backlash in less organized settings. In Surrey specifically, the existing infrastructure and the city's history as a diverse, immigrant-receiving community may have further buffered residents against negative reactions.

Taken together, the DiD results suggest that the relationship between refugee arrivals and right-wing voting is not automatic. Context matters: how a crisis is framed, how resettlement is organized, and what kind of community receives newcomers all shape whether the political response looks like sympathy or backlash. The Canadian case in 2015 offers one example of conditions under which a large, rapid refugee intake did not produce measurable political mobilization against it.

Policy Implications

The results suggest that large-scale refugee resettlement, when implemented through structured programs and framed as a humanitarian response, does not necessarily lead to a political backlash. While we cannot conclude that resettlement changes voting behaviour, we can rule out large increases in right-wing support. At the same time, the 2025 sentiment analysis shows that negative views toward immigration are more strongly associated with Conservative support, indicating that immigration can become politically salient under certain conditions. One

possible explanation is that economic pressures, such as the rising cost of living, may heighten concerns about immigration in ways that were less prominent during the 2015 refugee crisis. This implies that the political impact of immigration is context-dependent. Policymakers may therefore be able to reduce polarization by maintaining strong settlement support systems and by addressing broader economic concerns that shape how immigration is perceived.

These results enhance our previous understanding. Evidence on refugee arrivals and voting behavior came largely from European contexts where results are mixed, with some studies finding small but significant increases in right-wing support while others find no effect. The Canadian case falls within this range of findings. However, the 2025 sentiment data shows that anti-immigration attitudes remain associated with conservative support, suggesting that conditions which buffered against backlash in 2015 may not hold under different economic and political circumstances. Whether these shifts eventually translate into electoral outcomes remains an open question.

Conclusion

Right-wing extremism can manifest through anti-democratic values and its "secondary" manifestations are xenophobia or anti-immigrant rhetoric deployed during perceived crises (Carter, 2018). There are several studies, especially in Europe, on whether refugees impact voting behaviour and the radical right. This study conducts similar research in Canada to examine whether the Canadian context follows a similar pattern. Similar to our findings, almost all of these studies on refugee crises have shown that while there may have been small shifts, they aren’t statistically significant. Nonetheless, these studies have important implications for our theoretical understanding of the dynamic nature of attitudes toward asylum seekers, refugees and

protected migrants. Our results show that Canada follows a similar pattern to studies done in Europe on the Syrian Refugee crisis and voting behaviour.

Through our sentiment analysis, we have found a positive correlation between conservative votes and anti-immigrant sentiment, along with people's socioeconomic characteristics and their provincial location that shape their views. However, the difference-in-differences analysis indicates that we fail to reject the null hypothesis that refugee influx does not affect conservative support. Exogenous factors such as leader changes, initial exposure to immigrant populations, and economic conditions may affect the 6.7% decrease in right-wing support. The absence of increased conservative support may also be explained by the humanitarian framing of the Syrian crisis. Public sympathy toward refugees may have dampened the threat perceptions that typically drive voters toward restrictive immigration parties. Nonetheless, while our findings suggest that there was no significant electoral backlash in Canada during the 2015 refugee crisis, our sentiment analysis indicates that anti-immigrant attitudes remain associated with conservative support. This suggests that the political landscape surrounding immigration may have evolved, making it an important area for future research as economic and social conditions continue to shape public opinion.

Several questions emerge from this study worth pursuing. Specifically, whether economic and political conditions affect the refugee-voting relationship, as our sentiment data captures attitudes at a single point and cannot speak to how these may have evolved in response to underlying economic and political conditions. Whether humanitarian framing consistently reduces political backlash. Whether a larger city-level sample would produce statistically significant results is another question, given that our confidence intervals reflect data constraints as much as the absence of effect.

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Appendix

Table 1: Weighted Ordinal Logistic Regression Results

	Logistic Model
Conservative	2.485***
	(0.487)
NDP	0.662+
	(0.156)
High School or Less	1.468+
	(0.329)
College / Trades	1.563*
	(0.286)
Age: 35–54	1.434+
	(0.313)
Quebec	0.523**
	(0.113)
British Columbia	0.581*
	(0.141)
Atlantic & Territories	0.480**
	(0.131)
n	1096

+ p < 0.1, * p < 0.05, ** p < 0.01, *** p < 0.001

Source: Innovative Research Group. November, 2025 Survey

Note: Dropped non-significant coefficients, undecided respondents, and Bloc Québécois

Table 2: Difference-in-Difference results

	(1)
(Intercept)	0.203
	(0.181)
Surrey x Post (DiD Estimate)	-0.067
	(0.095)
Num.Obs.	390
R2	0.189
R2 Adj.	0.131

Controls included but omitted from table: age, gender, income, city fixed effects, year fixed effects. Surrey (treated) absorbed by city fixed effects. Standard errors in parentheses. * p<0.1, ** p<0.05, *** p<0.01

DiD: Conservative Support in Surrey